Performance over time. The 2000s showed the best performance (upward breakouts), and the other two decades were about even for performance. Downward breakouts showed the worst performance in the 2000s, and the other two decades were similar.

That makes sense to me. If upward breakouts excel in the 2000s, then downward breakouts probably do worse. And that's what we see.

Failures over time. Upward breakouts show failures increasing over time but downward breakouts show a mix.

Table 73.9 shows busted pattern performance.

Busted patterns count. As poor as wedges perform, I would expect to see higher bust counts (like 40% to 50%).

Busted occurrence. I sorted the busts into how many times they busted. We see single busts happening most often followed by double busts (in two columns) or triple+ busts (meaning more than two busts) after downward breakouts.

Busted and non-busted performance. In two of three columns, busted patterns outperform their non-busted counterparts. If you see a falling wedge with a busted downward breakout, then look for nearby (within 10% or so) overhead resistance. If you find none or a small amount, then consider buying the stock. If it single busts, the rise averages 53%, which is large enough that maybe you can grab part of it. The number is an average of perfect trades, so keep that in mind.

Note that for a downward breakout to bust, price has to drop no more than 10% below the bottom of the wedge and then close above the top of it. To clear the top of the wedge, that often means a big rise. I measured the 53% average rise from the top of the wedge (not the upward breakout) to the ultimate high.